f1weekend.co: status report and plan

12 October 2026 · Covers the work from the end of September to now: what is live on **f1weekend.co** (production), what is waiting on **staging.f1weekend.co**, what you need to do, and the plan to the end of the season and into 2027.

> **In one paragraph.** The site now compares tours from GetYourGuide, Viator and Tiqets for every remaining race. It shows red "Check availability" buttons where visitors actually look: picks at the top of race pages and tours that fit each free slot on the schedule pages. It also runs a different SEO technique on each remaining race, so we can choose the best one for 2027.
>
> The tracking proves the affiliate links work: GetYourGuide's dashboard shows our campaign tags and matches our own click counts. The site is not earning yet because almost nobody visits. Last month there were about 60–100 real visitors and 0 clicks from Google, so getting found on Google and Bing is now the main job.
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> The click dashboard, the daily/weekly email reports and the Las Vegas guide are built and on staging. They need one "push to production" to start working on the live site.

1. Where everything stands

Item	Status	Notes
Live tours from GetYourGuide + Viator + Tiqets for every remaining race	LIVE	Viator and Tiqets keys set on Vercel; not every race has all three sites (e.g. São Paulo has no Tiqets), which is fine.
Map with tours spread out, picks, mixed sites, "N sites compared", even card heights	LIVE	Singapore fixes 1–5, released with PR #45.
SEO tests: USA answer-first, Mexico topic cluster, São Paulo unique data	LIVE	USA and Mexico since 30 Sep, São Paulo since 5 Oct. Singapore is the control.
Sitemap with real "last changed" dates; www → f1weekend.co	LIVE	Released 5 Oct (PR #50). You resubmit the sitemap in Search Console.
Red Book buttons between sessions (schedule pages) + picks at top of race pages	LIVE	Released 5 Oct (PR #53), before the Singapore weekend.
Full-width layout on race, schedule, Getting There, Tips, topic and calendar pages	LIVE	Released 5 Oct (PR #53).
Click dashboard `/stats` (every click, by site / race / page / placement)	STAGING	Already shows the live site's clicks, because staging uses the same database. Staying staging-only, as agreed.
Recording *which tour* was clicked and picks-vs-list for every click	STAGING	Starts on the live site at the next "push to production".

Daily (09:00 IST) and weekly (Mondays) click report, emailed via GitHub	STAGING	The scheduled job only runs from `main`, so it starts at the next release.
`?internal=1` flag to keep our own/test clicks out of the numbers	STAGING	Each team device opens the site once with `?internal=1`.
Las Vegas expert guide by Jamshed V Rajan + author page	STAGING	Hidden on the live site until Jamshed approves it, even after the next release.

2. What is live on f1weekend.co (production)

Booking and money

- **Three booking sites per race.** Tours from GetYourGuide, Viator and Tiqets are fetched live for every race from Bahrain onwards and cached for 6 hours.
  - When one site fails, the list isn't cached and is retried, so a site no longer disappears for hours.
  - Each card shows the cheapest site and "Also on …" for the others.
- **Affiliate tracking on every link.**
  - GetYourGuide `partner_id` + `cmp`, Viator `pid/mcid` + `campaign`, Tiqets `partner` + `tq_campaign`.
  - The campaign tag is `f1-<race>-<page>`, so partner dashboards show which race and page earned a booking.
  - **Confirmed working:** GetYourGuide shows `f1-bahrain-experiences` (4 clicks) and `f1-bahrain-home` (2 clicks), matching our own counts.
- **Book buttons where people look.**
  - **Schedule pages:** a new "What to book between sessions" section gives 3 tours for each free slot, travel time included. That's 21–27 red buttons per race, on the page people keep open for about 16 minutes.
  - **Race pages:** "Our picks for race weekend" right under the title.
  - **Homepage:** already had picks under the top banner.
- **Click logging:** every click is saved in our database with its booking site, time, page and visitor ID.

Tours, map and cards (Singapore fixes 1–5)

- **Honest locations:** tours sold with only a city-centre location say "Across Singapore" or "Hotel pick-up in …" instead of a fake exact spot.
- **Map:**
  - Those tours are spread around the centre as hollow "approximate" pins rather than one unreadable pile.
  - Groups split as you zoom in.
  - The Google Maps daily limit is kept: the map loads only when the visitor asks for it.
- **Landmarks:** tours at named landmarks (Gardens by the Bay, Marina Bay Sands and others) are placed at the landmark.
- **Mixed booking sites:** never more than 2 cards in a row from the same site; GetYourGuide used to fill the first page.

- **Even card heights**, the "N sites compared" badge, and red buttons everywhere.

SEO

- **USA (Austin), answer-first:** 7 real search questions answered in 40–60 words at the top of the page, with FAQ markup.
- **Mexico, topic cluster:** the race page plus pages for Day of the Dead, Where to stay, Weather & what to pack and Getting there.
  - Tour picks leave out party/drinks tours and tours with under 10 reviews.
- **São Paulo, unique data:**
  - Race-day rain for the last 10 Grands Prix (Open-Meteo).
  - The forecast once it's within 15 days.
  - Current standings and Interlagos winners by team (Jolpica).
  - Train and car travel times.
  - Tour price guide from about 270 listings.
  - Session-gap planner.
- **Sitemap:** real "last changed" dates and upcoming races first; old `-2026` addresses redirect.
- **One address:** `www.f1weekend.co` now redirects (308) to `f1weekend.co`.

3. On staging, waiting for release

See them at **staging.f1weekend.co**. Each item below goes live together at the next "push to production" (PRs #54–#60). The one exception is the Las Vegas guide, which stays hidden on the live site until approved.

What	Details
Click dashboard `staging.f1weekend.co/stats`	• Booking clicks for the last 7, 30 or 90 days, and how many people clicked. • Bots, staging and internal clicks are left out and counted separately. • Breakdowns: clicks per day, by booking site, race, page and placement, most clicked tours, and a list of every click. • It reads the live database, so the numbers are real. • On f1weekend.co it opens only with a secret key; you chose to keep it on staging.
Full click details	• Every click will record which tour it was. • It will record whether the click came from the picks or the main list. • Bots are never recorded as a tour.
Daily and weekly reports	• **Schedule:** a GitHub job posts a report to an issue called "Booking clicks report" every day at 09:00 IST (yesterday's clicks), plus a weekly report on Mondays. • **Contents:** clicks and people compared with the previous period, by site, race, page and placement, the most clicked tours, and every click. • **By email:** GitHub emails each new comment to anyone subscribed to the issue.

Internal-traffic flag	• Opening any page with `?internal=1` marks that browser as ours. • Its clicks count as "test clicks", and it sends no analytics events. • `?internal=0` clears it.
Las Vegas guide (SEO test: expert guide)	• **Contents:** "Las Vegas Grand Prix 2026: the complete guide", 1,666 words in 8 sections: ◦ Session times in PT, ET and GMT. ◦ The circuit. ◦ Tickets zone by zone, with 2026 prices. ◦ Road closures, the Monorail and the bridges. ◦ Where to stay. ◦ Weather and what to wear. ◦ Daytime trips with Book buttons (Grand Canyon, Hoover Dam, Red Rock). ◦ Tips. • **Sources:** 34 in total, listed under each section. • **Search target:** "F1 Las Vegas" (34k searches/month) and "Las Vegas Grand Prix" (20k). • **Lap record:** corrected to Verstappen's 1:33.365 (2025) on the same page.
Author page `/authors/jamshed-v-rajan`	• Photo, "Researched & written by", bio and favourite cities. • Link to his Better Vacation profile. • Google-readable author markup. • Hidden on the live site until the guide is approved.

4. The numbers so far

~60–100	0	22	~2
real visitors / month (Ahrefs, 5 Sep–5 Oct; ~230 total incl. bots)	clicks from Google in 30 days (≈40 impressions, positions 70–90)	visitors from Bing (most of our search traffic)	real booking clicks in the week to 6 Oct (11 logged, most were our tests)

- **Where visitors spend time:**
  - Schedule pages: about 16 minutes. This is why the Book buttons went there.
  - Homepage: about 80 seconds.
  - Race pages: about 12 seconds. This is why the picks moved to the top.
- **Booking clicks (our database):** 27 in 90 days, 19 in 30 days, 11 in the 7 days to 5 Oct.
  - Most of the 11 were our own checks or automated tests.
  - The real ones were on the Mexico Day of the Dead page and on Singapore via Tiqets.
- **Bookings:** GetYourGuide shows 0 so far. Partner dashboards are the only place bookings and commission appear.
- **Bottom line:** the shop works; there are just very few people in it yet. A typical tour affiliate site turns about 1% of visitors into a booking worth roughly $5–40 commission, so traffic is what has to grow.

5. The SEO test (one technique per race, decided in December)

Race	Weekend	Technique	Status
Singapore	9–11 Oct	Control: standard page, nothing new	LIVE race over
USA (Austin)	23–25 Oct	Answer-first: short answers to real questions	LIVE since 30 Sep
Mexico City	30 Oct–1 Nov	Topic cluster: extra focused pages	LIVE since 30 Sep
São Paulo	6–8 Nov	Unique data: weather history, form guide, travel times, prices	LIVE since 5 Oct
Las Vegas	19–21 Nov	Expert guide: long, sourced, named author	STAGING awaiting Jamshed's approval
Qatar	27–29 Nov	Freshness: page updated weekly with what changed	TO BUILD ~27 Oct
Abu Dhabi	4–6 Dec	Validation: the best two techniques combined	TO BUILD ~4 Nov

Changes made to every race at once (sitemap, Book buttons, wider layout) are logged in `docs/seo-experiments/README.md`. Races are compared with each other, not with the past. Method, weekly logs and the 2027 playbook are in `docs/seo-experiments/`.

6. What you need to do

#	Action	Why / how
1	**Say "push to production"** YOU	Turns on full click tracking (which tour, picks vs list) and the daily/weekly reports. The Las Vegas guide stays hidden.
2	**Subscribe to the "Booking clicks report" issue** on GitHub YOU	It's created the first time the report runs, right after the release. Click "Subscribe" on the issue to receive the reports by email.
3	**Open `f1weekend.co/?internal=1` once on every team device** YOU	Keeps your own clicks out of the numbers. Add it to the Playwright test suite's start URL too, because tests were a large share of last week's clicks.
4	**Jamshed reviews the Las Vegas guide** YOU	Read it at `staging.f1weekend.co/races/las-vegas`; his name is on it. Spot-check: • 2026 ticket prices (from F1's on-sale release, Sports Illustrated and 8 News Now). • Road closures (the 2025 plan, since the 2026 plan isn't published). • Race-time temperatures (forecasts). Then tell the developer "Las Vegas approved". Ideally before about 20 Oct, a month ahead of the race.
5	**Google Search Console:** resubmit `sitemap.xml` and request indexing YOU	For `/races/usa`, `/races/mexico`, `/races/mexico/day-of-the-dead`, `/races/brazil` (and `/races/las-vegas` once approved). Google still lists old addresses.
6	**Bing Webmaster Tools:** add the site (import from Search Console) YOU	Bing already sends most of our search visitors, and ChatGPT search uses Bing's index. About 5 minutes.
7	**Check the GetYourGuide, Viator and Tiqets dashboards weekly** YOU	That's where bookings and commission appear. Match them to our clicks using the `f1-<race>-<page>` campaign tags.
8	**Sign up for a hotel partner** (Booking.com via Awin, or Expedia) YOU	One race-week hotel booking pays more than many tours. Once approved, a hotel block can go on the "where to stay" sections.
9	**Post helpful answers** on r/F1Travel and r/formula1 race threads YOU	Almost nothing links to the site yet. The developer can draft answers linking the useful pages, such as the Interlagos train table or the Vegas guide.
10	**Delete the feature branch** after the release YOU	Per the branching rules, you delete branches.

7. What the developer does next

#	Task	When / notes

1	Release staging → production, run the report once by hand, check the issue appears **DEV**	As soon as you say "push to production". Then check tours are recorded on live clicks.
2	Switch on the Las Vegas guide **DEV**	When approved: set `approved: true`, record its start date in `seo-experiments.ts` and `docs/seo-experiments/las-vegas.md`, and request indexing.
3	Fill in the SEO scorecard and weekly logs **DEV**	Due now (from 7–10 Oct), weekly after that. Singapore (control) has finished, so record its numbers.
4	Add IndexNow so Bing re-reads changed pages within hours **DEV**	About 1 hour, after you add the site to Bing Webmaster Tools.
5	Build Qatar "freshness" (weekly "what changed" updates) **DEV**	Live by about 27 Oct.
6	Build Abu Dhabi "validation" (best two techniques combined) **DEV**	Live by about 4 Nov, using the early results from USA, Mexico, São Paulo and Las Vegas.
7	Put race tickets and race-day transfers first **DEV**	Where GetYourGuide or Viator sell grandstand tickets or circuit transfers, show them first: fans search for tickets far more than tours.
8	Hotel block on "where to stay" **DEV**	After you sign up with a hotel partner.
9	Draft forum answers for you to post **DEV**	For each upcoming race, link the useful pages.
10	Check race rollover **DEV**	After each race, confirm the homepage and "next race" switch to the next one (USA after Singapore).
11	Viator/Tiqets offers for older database races (e.g. Monaco) **DEV**	Lower priority. Those races are over for 2026 but rank all year.

8. Plan: rest of 2026 and 2027

When	What
This week (12–18 Oct)	• Release tracking and reports, and subscribe to the issue. • Search Console resubmit and Bing setup. • Jamshed's review. • First daily reports arrive. • Scorecard week 1.
19–25 Oct	• Las Vegas guide live (a month before the race). • IndexNow. • USA race weekend: watch schedule-page clicks for Austin. • Hotel partner application.

26 Oct–8 Nov	• Qatar freshness test live. • Mexico and São Paulo race weekends. • Abu Dhabi validation live (~4 Nov). • Weekly reports compare races.
9 Nov–6 Dec	• Las Vegas (biggest search demand: Grand Canyon and Hoover Dam tours pay best), Qatar and Abu Dhabi weekends. • Keep the Las Vegas guide's facts up to date as the 2026 road plan is published.
December	• **Verdict:** compare the techniques on impressions, clicks, positions, AI citations and booking clicks per race. • Write the 2027 playbook in `docs/seo-experiments/2027-playbook.md`.
Jan–Feb 2027	• Rebuild all 24 race pages with the winning technique before the season, so they rank before demand rises. • The race addresses stay the same every year (`/races/<race>`), so this year's rankings carry over.
2027 season	• Tours, tickets and hotels from multiple partners for every race. • Daily click reports. • Named-author guides for the biggest races. • Goal: steady search traffic, so the booking buttons turn into commission.

9. Reference

What	Where
Live site / staging	`https://f1weekend.co` · `https://staging.f1weekend.co`
Click dashboard	`https://staging.f1weekend.co/stats` (7 / 30 / 90 days)
Report (raw)	`https://staging.f1weekend.co/api/stats-report?period=daily` or `weekly`
Las Vegas guide / author (staging)	`/races/las-vegas` · `/authors/jamshed-v-rajan`
Releases to production	PR #45 (Singapore fixes + Viator/Tiqets), #50 (São Paulo + sitemap), #53 (Book buttons + full width)
On staging, not yet released	PRs #54–#60 (dashboard, click details, reports, internal flag, Las Vegas guide + author page, lap-record fix)
Key code	`src/lib/click-stats.ts` (report logic) · `src/services/click-stats.service.ts` · `.github/workflows/click-report.yml` · `src/data/expert-guides-2026.ts` (`approved` switch) · `src/data/seo-experiments.ts`
Release rule	Feature branch → PR into `staging` → you check staging → "push to production" → `staging` → `main`. Vercel only builds `main` and `staging`.

Prepared 12 Oct 2026. Visitor figures come from Ahrefs Web Analytics and Google Search Console (5 Sep–5 Oct); click figures from the site's own database and the GetYourGuide partner dashboard.